

Section A: Extract-Based Comprehension (3 × 5 = 15 marks)

□ **Extract 1:**

“Aunt Jennifer’s tigers prance across a screen, Bright topaz denizens of a world of green. They do not fear the men beneath the tree; They pace in sleek chivalric certainty.”

1. Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs)

Q1: What does “bright topaz denizens” refer to?

- (a) Aunt Jennifer’s jewelry
- (b) The tigers’ color and habitat
- (c) The embroidery thread
- (d) The forest trees **Answer:** (b) The tigers’ color and habitat

Q2: What does “chivalric certainty” suggest about the tigers?

- (a) They are timid
- (b) They are noble and fearless
- (c) They are confused
- (d) They are playful **Answer:** (b) They are noble and fearless

2. Assertion-Reasoning Questions

Q3: Assertion: The tigers are symbols of strength and confidence. Reason: They are described as prancing fearlessly and nobly.

- (a) Both Assertion and Reason are true, and Reason is the correct explanation of Assertion.
- (b) Both Assertion and Reason are true, but Reason is not the correct explanation of Assertion.
- (c) Assertion is true, but Reason is false.
- (d) Assertion is false, but Reason is true. **Answer:** (a) Both Assertion and Reason are true, and Reason is the correct explanation of Assertion

Q4: Assertion: Aunt Jennifer’s tigers are afraid of men. Reason: They live in a dangerous forest.

- (a) Both Assertion and Reason are true, and Reason is the correct explanation of Assertion.
- (b) Both Assertion and Reason are true, but Reason is not the correct explanation of Assertion.
- (c) Assertion is true, but Reason is false.
- (d) Assertion is false, but Reason is true. **Answer:** (d) Assertion is false, but Reason is true

3. Fill in the Blanks

Q5: Aunt Jennifer's tigers move with _____ certainty. **Answer:** chivalric

4. Choose the Words and Pick the Right Choice

Q6: Which word best describes the tone used to depict the tigers?

- (a) Fearful
- (b) Humorous
- (c) Admiring
- (d) Critical **Answer:** (c) Admiring

□ Extract 2:

"Aunt Jennifer's fingers fluttering through her wool Find even the ivory needle hard to pull.
The massive weight of Uncle's wedding band Sits heavily upon Aunt Jennifer's hand."

1. Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs)

Q1: What does "fluttering fingers" suggest about Aunt Jennifer?

- (a) She is excited
- (b) She is nervous and weak
- (c) She is confident
- (d) She is angry **Answer:** (b) She is nervous and weak

Q2: What does the "wedding band" symbolize?

- (a) Love and commitment
- (b) Artistic inspiration
- (c) Burden of marital oppression
- (d) Wealth and status **Answer:** (c) Burden of marital oppression

2. Assertion-Reasoning Questions

Q3: Assertion: Aunt Jennifer finds it hard to pull the needle. Reason: She is physically weak and emotionally burdened.

- (a) Both Assertion and Reason are true, and Reason is the correct explanation of Assertion.
- (b) Both Assertion and Reason are true, but Reason is not the correct explanation of Assertion.
- (c) Assertion is true, but Reason is false.
- (d) Assertion is false, but Reason is true. **Answer:** (a) Both Assertion and Reason are true, and Reason is the correct explanation of Assertion

Q4: Assertion: The wedding band is a symbol of joy. Reason: Aunt Jennifer wears it proudly.

- (a) Both Assertion and Reason are true, and Reason is the correct explanation of Assertion.
- (b) Both Assertion and Reason are true, but Reason is not the correct explanation of Assertion.
- (c) Assertion is true, but Reason is false.
- (d) Assertion is false, but Reason is true. **Answer:** (d) Assertion is false, but Reason is true

3. Fill in the Blanks

Q5: Aunt Jennifer's needle is made of _____. **Answer:** ivory

4. Choose the Words and Pick the Right Choice

Q6: Which word best describes Aunt Jennifer's emotional state in this extract?

- (a) Joyful
- (b) Oppressed
- (c) Confident
- (d) Indifferent **Answer:** (b) Oppressed

□ Extract 3:

"When Aunt is dead, her terrified hands will lie Still ringed with ordeals she was mastered by. The tigers in the panel that she made Will go on prancing, proud and unafraid."

1. Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs)

Q1: What does "terrified hands" imply?

- (a) Aunt Jennifer's fear and suffering
- (b) Her excitement
- (c) Her strength
- (d) Her creativity **Answer:** (a) Aunt Jennifer's fear and suffering

Q2: What does "ringed with ordeals" symbolize?

- (a) Her jewelry
- (b) Her artistic talent
- (c) Her lifelong struggles
- (d) Her family traditions **Answer:** (c) Her lifelong struggles

2. Assertion-Reasoning Questions

Q3: Assertion: Aunt Jennifer's tigers will remain fearless even after her death. Reason: They represent her inner desire for freedom.

- (a) Both Assertion and Reason are true, and Reason is the correct explanation of Assertion.
- (b) Both Assertion and Reason are true, but Reason is not the correct explanation of Assertion.
- (c) Assertion is true, but Reason is false.
- (d) Assertion is false, but Reason is true. **Answer:** (a) Both Assertion and Reason are true, and Reason is the correct explanation of Assertion

Q4: Assertion: Aunt Jennifer's death will free her from all suffering. Reason: She will be remembered through her art.

- (a) Both Assertion and Reason are true, and Reason is the correct explanation of Assertion.
- (b) Both Assertion and Reason are true, but Reason is not the correct explanation of Assertion.
- (c) Assertion is true, but Reason is false.

- (d) Assertion is false, but Reason is true. **Answer:** (c) Assertion is true, but Reason is false

3. Fill in the Blanks

Q5: Aunt Jennifer's tigers will remain _____ and unafraid. **Answer:** proud

4. Choose the Words and Pick the Right Choice

Q6: Which word best describes the tone of the final stanza?

- (a) Hopeful
- (b) Tragic
- (c) Triumphant
- (d) Humorous **Answer:** (c) Triumphant

Section B: Short Answer Questions (12 × 2 = 24 marks)

Each answer is within 50 words and includes a marking scheme.

□ Story-Based Questions (3 × 2 Marks = 6 Marks)

Q1. What do Aunt Jennifer's tigers symbolize? Answer: Aunt Jennifer's tigers symbolize strength, courage, and freedom. They represent the qualities she longs for but cannot express due to her oppressive marriage. The tigers are fearless and proud, unlike Aunt Jennifer herself. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark for identifying the symbol
- 1 mark for explaining its contrast with Aunt Jennifer

Q2. Why is Aunt Jennifer unable to pull the ivory needle easily? Answer: Aunt Jennifer struggles with the needle because of her physical frailty and emotional burden. The "massive weight of Uncle's wedding band" symbolizes the patriarchal pressure that restricts her freedom and creativity. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark for describing her physical/emotional state
- 1 mark for linking it to the wedding band

Q3. What does "ringed with ordeals" suggest about Aunt Jennifer's life? Answer: The phrase "ringed with ordeals" suggests that Aunt Jennifer's life was surrounded by suffering and restrictions. The word "ringed" also refers to her wedding ring, symbolizing the oppressive nature of her marriage. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark for interpreting "ringed"
- 1 mark for linking it to her suffering

□ Value-Based Questions (3 × 2 Marks = 6 Marks)

Q4. What values are reflected in Aunt Jennifer's embroidery work? Answer: Her embroidery reflects values of freedom, bravery, and dignity. Through her art, Aunt Jennifer expresses the strength she cannot live, showing her inner desire to break free from societal constraints. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark for identifying values
- 1 mark for linking them to her art

Q5. How does the poet highlight gender oppression in the poem? Answer: Adrienne Rich uses symbols like the wedding band and Aunt Jennifer's trembling fingers to depict the

emotional and physical burden of patriarchal control. The contrast between Aunt and her tigers emphasizes gender-based oppression. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark for identifying oppression
- 1 mark for citing poetic devices

Q6. What lesson does the poem offer about self-expression? Answer: The poem teaches that self-expression can be a form of resistance. Aunt Jennifer's tigers reflect her inner strength and desire for freedom, even though she cannot live those qualities openly.

Marking Scheme:

- 1 mark for stating the lesson
- 1 mark for linking it to Aunt's art

□ **Competency-Based Questions (4 × 2 Marks = 8 Marks)**

Q7. How does the poet use contrast to build meaning in the poem? Answer: The poet contrasts Aunt Jennifer's timid reality with the boldness of her tigers. This contrast highlights the gap between her inner desires and external limitations, deepening the poem's emotional impact. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark for identifying the contrast
- 1 mark for explaining its effect

Q8. What does the wedding band symbolize in the poem? Answer: The wedding band symbolizes the burden of marital obligations and patriarchal dominance. It weighs heavily on Aunt Jennifer's hand, representing the emotional and societal constraints she faces. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark for identifying the symbol
- 1 mark for interpreting its meaning

Q9. Why will Aunt Jennifer's tigers continue to prance after her death? Answer: The tigers will continue to prance because they represent Aunt Jennifer's artistic legacy and unspoken strength. Her embroidery outlives her, symbolizing the endurance of her suppressed spirit. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark for stating the reason
- 1 mark for linking it to symbolism

Q10. How does the poem reflect Adrienne Rich's feminist ideology? Answer: The poem reflects Rich's feminist ideology by portraying Aunt Jennifer as a victim of patriarchal control. Through her art, she expresses resistance, highlighting the struggle for female autonomy and voice. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark for identifying feminist theme
- 1 mark for supporting with textual evidence

□ **Section C: Long Answer Questions (4 × 5 = 20 marks)**

Each answer is 150–200 words, structured in three paragraphs (Introduction, Content, Conclusion), with marking scheme.

1 □ **Theme-Based Question**

Q: Discuss the theme of gender oppression in Aunt Jennifer's Tigers.

Answer: Adrienne Rich's poem *Aunt Jennifer's Tigers* explores the theme of gender oppression through the life of Aunt Jennifer, a woman trapped in a patriarchal marriage. The poem contrasts her timid reality with the boldness of the tigers she embroiders.

Aunt Jennifer's trembling fingers and the "massive weight of Uncle's wedding band" symbolize the emotional and societal burdens she carries. Her inability to pull the needle reflects her lack of freedom and agency. In contrast, the tigers she creates are fearless and proud, moving with "chivalric certainty." This contrast highlights the gap between her inner desires and external limitations.

Through powerful imagery and symbolism, Rich critiques the constraints placed on women and celebrates the enduring spirit of resistance. Aunt Jennifer's art becomes her voice, and even after her death, her tigers continue to prance—unafraid and free. The poem is a poignant reflection on the silent struggles of women and the power of creative expression.

Marking Scheme (5 marks):

- 1 mark: Introduction of theme
- 2 marks: Textual examples and analysis
- 1 mark: Interpretation and insight
- 1 mark: Coherent conclusion

2 Character-Based Question

Q: Describe Aunt Jennifer's character and her emotional state.

Answer: Aunt Jennifer is portrayed as a timid and oppressed woman, burdened by the responsibilities and restrictions of her marriage. Her physical frailty and emotional fear are evident in her trembling fingers and inability to pull the needle.

She is emotionally subdued, yet her inner world is rich with imagination and courage. Through her embroidery, she creates tigers that are bold and fearless—qualities she admires but cannot embody. The "massive weight of Uncle's wedding band" symbolizes the control and dominance she experiences, making her emotionally fragile and submissive.

Despite her limitations, Aunt Jennifer's art reflects her silent rebellion. Her tigers will continue to prance even after her death, symbolizing the strength she could not live but could express. Her character is a blend of vulnerability and resilience, making her a powerful symbol of suppressed womanhood.

Marking Scheme (5 marks):

- 1 mark: Introduction of character
- 2 marks: Description with textual support
- 1 mark: Emotional insight
- 1 mark: Conclusion with interpretation

3 Value-Based Question

Q: What values and lessons does the poem convey to readers?

Answer: *Aunt Jennifer's Tigers* conveys values of courage, self-expression, and resilience. It teaches that even in oppressive circumstances, one can find ways to express inner strength and preserve dignity.

Aunt Jennifer's embroidery becomes a symbol of her unspoken resistance. Though she is physically and emotionally constrained, her tigers reflect bravery and freedom. The poem emphasizes the importance of creative expression as a means of survival and protest. It also highlights the enduring nature of art, which can outlive the artist and continue to inspire. The poem encourages readers to recognize the silent struggles of women and to value the power of imagination and expression. It is a call for empathy, awareness, and change, reminding us that strength can exist even in silence.

Marking Scheme (5 marks):

- 1 mark: Identification of values
- 2 marks: Supporting examples from the text
- 1 mark: Relevance to broader context
- 1 mark: Conclusion with reflection

4☐ Symbolism-Based Question

Q: Explain the use of symbolism in Aunt Jennifer's Tigers.

Answer: Adrienne Rich uses rich symbolism in *Aunt Jennifer's Tigers* to convey deeper meanings about gender roles and emotional repression. The tigers symbolize freedom, courage, and the spirit of resistance.

The "wedding band" is a powerful symbol of patriarchal control. It weighs heavily on Aunt Jennifer's hand, representing the emotional burden of her marriage. Her "fluttering fingers" symbolize her fragility and fear. In contrast, the tigers she embroiders are bold and unafraid, moving with "chivalric certainty." This contrast between the creator and her creation highlights the gap between her inner desires and external reality.

Even after Aunt Jennifer's death, her tigers continue to prance, symbolizing the lasting impact of her artistic expression. Rich's use of symbolism transforms a domestic scene into a powerful feminist statement, making the poem both personal and political.

Marking Scheme (5 marks):

- 1 mark: Identification of symbols
- 2 marks: Explanation with textual support
- 1 mark: Interpretation of meaning
- 1 mark: Conclusion with insight